SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

AN ASSESSMENT OF THE PREPAREDNESS OF CONVENTION FACILITIES IN BUTUAN CITY

A Thesis Proposal Presented To
The Faculty of
College of Tourism and Hospitality Management

In Partial Requirements for the Degree

By

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SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
College of Tourism and Hospitality Management

CERTIFICATE OF RESEARCH APPROVAL

This thesis entitled **"PREPAREDNESS IN CONVENTION AND FACILITIES IN BUTUAN CITY."** presented and submitted by **MARIEL M. DELFIN, JAN CEASARY A. CASTRODES, HANNAH SHARMAINE MONTANO, ANGEL MAE B. FABROA, MADRIAN JOSEPH AVILA, RECAH JHOANA L. ENCIO, JONATHAN JR. C. PENADOS** in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of **BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN TOURISM MANAGEMENT** is hereby accepted and recommended for Oral Examination.

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ABSTRACT

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III. FINDINGS

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IV. RECOMMENDATIONS

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Objectives
- **Write a short introduction of your paper. Provide the direction of the study and nuances.**

Methodology
- **Provide the specific method that was used in your paper and the important details such as how did you do it.**

Findings
- **Highlight the significant findings of your paper.**

Recommendation
- **Just highlight the primary recommendation**

KEYWORDS: PROVIDE AT LEAST 5

Check guidelines for writing an abstract for further details. Max of 250 words from objective 1-5

Write it in paragraph form narrative. See sample IN YOUR DISCUSSION

DEDICATION

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS



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CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

Meetings, Incentives, Conventions, and Events (MICE) is one of the most dynamic sectors of global tourism, driving economic growth, destination competitiveness, and international collaboration (Galapate et al., 2024). Across major destinations, the MICE industry stimulates job creation, boosts hotel and transportation sectors, and attracts high-value business travelers. The post-pandemic landscape further emphasizes the importance of safe, innovative, and resilient event spaces as destinations worldwide strive to rebuild confidence and meet rising expectations for digital integration and health-secure operations. As cities compete to reestablish their position in the business events market, readiness assessments become crucial, especially in developing areas like Butuan City, where MICE preparedness is directly linked to future regional growth and economic vitality.

International studies highlight that MICE readiness depends on more than just physical structures; it requires strong organizational systems, efficient coordination, and digital adaptability. The Lao National Convention Center, for example, faces operational gaps in management and stakeholder coordination despite having promising infrastructure (Phanthanousy & Sribenjachot, 2021). In Indonesia, industry players report skill mismatches and emphasize the need for competency-based training aligned with regional standards (Erfinda et al., 2023). Research in Malaysia identifies uneven adoption of hybrid formats, digital technologies, and safety protocols, demonstrating that

destinations differ significantly in technology readiness and resilience (Sah et al., 2025). Globally, the MICE sector has evolved into a major driver of infrastructure investment, innovation, and sustainable development (Klinmalai & Kaewlai, 2024; Mair & Smith, 2021). However, many destinations continue to struggle with service consistency and digital transformation, reinforcing the need for holistic readiness assessments that examine facilities, technology, systems, and staff capabilities.

Within the Philippines, the Meetings, Incentives, Conventions, and Exhibitions Roadmap 2030 aims to position the country as a leading Asian MICE destination by improving event venues, enhancing workforce competence, and adopting regional standards (Blanquisco, 2024). Pandemic disruptions, however, severely affected local event enterprises, as illustrated in Ilocos Norte, where businesses experienced cancellations, revenue losses, and workforce reductions, prompting shifts to micro-events and hybrid formats (Bagaoisan et al., 2021). Research also shows uneven digital infrastructure across cities (Disimulacion, 2021), insufficient technological integration in Batangas venues (Hernandez, 2023), and mismatches between service quality and staff conditions in Davao (Hinlayagan et al., 2022a). Iloilo, despite being a high-traffic destination, still encounters branding and transportation issues (Aguilar & Hernandez, 2025). These studies reveal that while the Philippines is advancing in MICE development, facility readiness remains inconsistent, especially in emerging regional hubs. Very few studies assess MICE readiness in Mindanao, leaving a research gap that this study aims to fill by focusing on the preparedness of convention and event facilities in Butuan City.

Butuan City has strong potential as a Meetings, Incentives, Conventions, and Exhibitions destination in the Caraga region, thanks to its strategic location and growing tourism landscape. However, there remains a need to examine how its convention and event facilities align with current industry standards, especially since previous local studies, such as the work of Hernandez (2023) in Batangas, revealed that many regional venues still face challenges related to digital readiness, incomplete technology integration, and limited adaptation to modern event requirements. These gaps highlight the importance of evaluating whether Butuan City's facilities demonstrate similar limitations or possess distinct strengths that can support MICE development. This study will therefore assess the preparedness of convention venues in terms of their physical setup, technology use, coordination and service improvement, and staff service, while also exploring how these components interact. The results will provide essential insights that can guide local policy development, inform investment decisions, and support facility managers in modernizing their operations. For the College of Tourism and Hospitality Management at Saint Michael College of Caraga, this study will also enrich academic training, strengthen experiential learning, and contribute to community-engaged research.

The significance of this study lies in its ability to guide decision-making, support industry development, and strengthen Butuan's long-term competitiveness. Butuan City's Meetings, Incentives, Conventions, and Events sector. The findings will provide local government units with evidence-based insights that will inform policy formulation,

infrastructure planning, and sustainable tourism strategies. City officials and tourism planners will be able to use the results to determine which aspects of event facilities require improvement, such as safety systems, technological capabilities, and venue capacity, and these insights will influence future investments, regulatory updates, and collaborative initiatives. Venue owners and managers will also benefit, as the detailed assessment will identify gaps in physical maintenance, event coordination, lighting and sound systems, power reliability, and staff competencies. These results will guide their operational upgrades, improve customer satisfaction, and strengthen their ability to attract conventions, exhibitions, corporate gatherings, and educational events. The business community will likewise benefit from economic advantages, as improved Meetings, Incentives, Conventions, and Events readiness will attract more visitors, whose spending on accommodations, food, transportation, and local products will stimulate employment and support local enterprises. Students and faculty members from the College of Tourism and Hospitality Management will benefit academically, as the study will serve as a practical learning resource that enhances understanding of facility assessment, tourism operations, and event management. The results will support curriculum enhancement, skill development, and field-based learning opportunities. Ultimately, the broader tourism sector of Butuan City will benefit as strengthened event capability will elevate the city's reputation, attract regional and national gatherings, and contribute to sustainable economic growth in the Caraga region.

1.2 Review of Related Literature

Preparedness in MICE means a venue can run events safely across three areas. The first is the physical set-up**:** rooms, crowd flow, and risk controls. The second is technology**:** Audio Visual, power, Heating, Ventilation, and Air Conditioning, and digital services. The third is event services**:** coordination systems and staff performance. Studies after the pandemic show that health safety, interoperable tech, and dependable service shape event continuity and the attendee experience(Litvinova-Kulikova et al., 2023). In new places, readiness also depends on having sufficient staff, thorough training, and careful planning to ensure services remain consistent (Liu et al., 2022).

Largest Type of Event Handled

According to Hernandez (2023), the largest type of event handled by a venue significantly influences how preparedness is perceived and evaluated, as different event scales require varying levels of coordination, space configuration, and service delivery. His findings show that respondents who managed or attended larger events such as conventions, conferences, and exhibitions demonstrated higher expectations for venue readiness, particularly in coordination systems and service improvement. This suggests that operational demands increase with event size, making preparedness more complex and resource-intensive for venues hosting large-scale gatherings. Joseph & Calinao (2023) explain that large events, such as pop-culture conventions, generate heightened visitor activity, greater vendor engagement, and more intensive venue utilization. Their research highlights that these types of events require expanded space, improved crowd-

flow strategies, and stronger technical support to maintain smooth operations. Large-scale events also challenge staff coordination and onsite management due to the diversity of activities and the volume of attendees. In the international context, Lopes & Hiray (2024) emphasize that large cultural and festival-type events enhance tourism demand, extend visitor stays, and stimulate local economic activity. Their study indicates that higher attendance levels place increased pressure on venue facilities, requiring well-prepared public areas, efficient crowd distribution, and enhanced safety measures. These findings align with the need for greater operational readiness when managing larger event types. Despite these insights, Joseph & Calinao (2023) caution that many local event-related studies use non-probability sampling and subjective measures, which may limit the broader applicability of conclusions regarding event size and operational demands**.** This underscores the importance of contextualizing results within each venue's unique characteristics and capacity. Overall, the literature shows that the largest type of event handled affects how venues prepare, organize, and evaluate their operations. Large-scale gatherings require stronger coordination systems, flexible layouts, enhanced technology, and heightened safety preparedness, making event type a meaningful indicator of a venue's readiness level.

Lou & Huang (2023) focus on the exhibition segment of the MICE industry in Taiwan and develop a performance measurement scale that explicitly includes exhibition hall facilities as one of five core dimensions of exhibition performance. Their findings show that exhibition hall facilities, together with organizers' marketing skills, surrounding

environmental resources, professional competence, and green procurement practices, have a significant positive effect on exhibition performance (Lou & Huang, 2023). Because exhibitions generally involve large floor areas, multiple booths, and high visitor flows, these results imply that larger, better-equipped venues are critical for successfully hosting the biggest MICE events. For the present study, this supports the idea that when respondents report the largest type of event handled by their facility, large-scale exhibitions are likely to be associated with venues that have more extensive and specialized physical infrastructure.

Average Number of Attendees

The average number of attendees is widely treated as a practical indicator of event size, which in turn shapes how organizers plan and evaluate MICE operations. According to Vencint Hernandez (2023), variations in guest count do not necessarily change participants' ratings of physical setup and technology use, but they interact with the type of major event managed to influence perceptions of coordination and service improvement, suggesting that operating context matters beyond headcount alone. In MICE-satellite venues, this means that average attendance helps signal the scale of coordination required yet must be interpreted alongside event characteristics when assessing preparedness. Gandarosa (2023) emphasizes that the average number of attendees is a key MICE metric because it signals event size and directly guides decisions on venue selection, budgeting, staffing levels, and program design. In the study of festival and event participants, higher or lower typical attendance was linked to different

expectations for site management and service delivery, even when evaluations of physical tools and applications remained similar across groups.

Therefore, strong service and practical green-meeting practices will increase perceived value and will contribute to satisfaction (Firman Sinaga et al., 2020).Rashwan (2022)observed that an uneven sex distribution among attendees provides planners with clues for structuring assessments.

Preparedness of Physical Setup

Hernandez (2023) explains that in MICE, readiness is more than running the event. After COVID-19, venues must clearly explain health and safety rules. Layout choices now affect how safe, satisfied, and confident people feel. In practice, space planning and readiness go hand in hand.

In Batangas, most venues will use spaced-out seating, better ventilation, clear signs, sanitation facilities, and isolation areas. Staff training and facility updates will also be important (Hernandez, 2023). Studies will show what works. Planners will redesign sign-up to avoid contact, offer both in-person and online options, and rearrange rooms for distanced seating, smoother movement, and on-site tech that will support remote attendees (Yao et al., 2021).Future research will describe new venue needs that will become important post-pandemic: flexible rooms that can change layout quickly; good airflow/ventilation; clear crowd flow with wide corridors and wayfinding signs; strong cleaning routines; accessibility for all guests (Melly et al., 2023).

Meetings and Function Rooms

Meetings and function rooms form the central physical space where conventions, seminars, and gatherings take place, making their preparedness critical to the overall success and safety of MICE events**.** Hernandez (2023) indicates how venues in the Philippines enhanced ventilation, ensured cleanliness, adopted flexible room layouts, and integrated pre-function areas to meet the demands of post-pandemic event management. These improvements reflect an increasing expectation among organizers and participants for adaptable, comfortable, and secure environments that support both small and large-scale activities. Similarly, An et al. (2021) emphasize that the spatial quality, size, room configuration, and availability of audiovisual resources in meeting and function rooms significantly influence participant satisfaction and operational efficiency. Their findings show that well-prepared rooms equipped with dependable sound systems, proper seating arrangements, and accessible breakout spaces strengthen a venue's competitiveness in the MICE sector. Compliance with national protocols, such as the DOT–DTI Joint Memorandum Circular No. 2021-001, further required venues to implement distancing guidelines, add sanitation stations, and post directional signage to ensure the safety of attendees during and after the pandemic (DOT-DTI-Joint-Memorandum-Circular-No-2021-001, 2021). Supporting regional evidence, Aguilar & Hernandez (2025) found that strong infrastructure, appropriate room layout, and adherence to safety guidelines significantly contributed to Iloilo City's reputation as an emerging MICE destination**.** Their work reinforces the view that meeting and function rooms must be

clean, well-ventilated, and logically arranged to meet global expectations and achieve competitiveness. International studies also agree.

Meeting Rooms and Public Areas

Hernandez (2023) stated that meeting rooms and public areas play a pivotal role in venue preparedness because they determine crowd movement, comfort, and safety throughout the event experience. His study highlights that Filipino venues improved their public spaces by enhancing circulation pathways, upgrading ventilation in lobbies and hallways, and ensuring that restrooms, corridors, and holding areas were clean and well-maintained to support MICE operations. These improvements made public areas more conducive to large gatherings and helped align venues with national and international safety expectations. Similarly, the condition and accessibility of meeting rooms and shared spaces directly affect guest satisfaction and operational efficiency, and their findings also show that well-designed layouts, visible signage, and organized registration areas reduce congestion and enhance the overall guest experience (An et al., 2021). International ventilation research further supports these claims, demonstrating that public areas must maintain adequate airflow and avoid stale air, especially when CO_2 levels approach or exceed 1,500 ppm, prompting venues to improve natural ventilation or deploy mechanical airflow solutions (De-Ville et al., 2025). Crowd-management studies by Drakeley & Brown (2022)meeting rooms and public areas must be designed to prevent bottlenecks and minimize risky crowd density. Their work identifies essential strategies such as one-way walking routes, expanded foyer spaces, monitored queues, and clear

visual markers to guide participants safely. These measures help maintain orderly movement during high-traffic periods such as registration, intermissions, and meal breaks. Supporting local perspectives, Aguilar & Hernandez (2025) found that well-organized lobbies, clean restrooms, spacious hallways, and functional pre-function spaces contributed significantly to Iloilo City's perceived competitiveness as a MICE destination. Their study reveals that public areas must be comfortable, safe, and visually coherent to meet global standards and improve the marketability of Philippine venues. Similarly, regional tourism research shows that cleanliness, signage clarity, accessibility, and well-maintained facilities are strong predictors of customer satisfaction and perceived readiness.

Safety, Security, and Emergency Facilities

According to Hernandez (2023), safety, security, and emergency facilities are fundamental components of venue preparedness because they ensure that MICE events can operate smoothly while protecting participants from risks and disruptions. His study highlights that Filipino venues prioritized emergency exits, clear safety protocols, functional ventilation systems, and cleanliness measures to safeguard attendees, especially in the post-pandemic period. These efforts demonstrate that safety infrastructure is no longer optional but essential for gaining the trust of both organizers and participants.

Supporting these findings, Evangelista & Ylagan (2022) emphasize that adequate emergency preparedness requires the availability of first-aid stations, isolation rooms, and trained staff who can respond effectively to medical incidents and emergencies. Their study revealed that many local venues still face challenges related to incomplete safety facilities, insufficient coordination, and limited staff training, which can affect the overall performance of MICE operations.

Such limitations underscore the need for continuous improvement in emergency preparedness. International perspectives also reinforce these concerns. Hutton et al. (2024) argue that safety and security in event venues depend on the integration of situational-awareness tools, incident reporting procedures, and coordinated emergency workflows. Their research recommends the use of advanced monitoring systems and trained security personnel to maintain order and prevent potential threats. These measures ensure that venues can identify risks early and respond proactively. Public health institutions likewise emphasize preparedness.

The European Centre for Disease Prevention and Control (Ecdc, 2024) stresses the importance of ventilation, crowd management, sanitation, and communication protocols to prevent the spread of infectious diseases during large gatherings. Their guidelines recommend maintaining good airflow, organizing queues, managing density in public areas, and ensuring visibility of hygiene reminders to support participant safety (Ecdc, 2024). Such protocols remain relevant even after the height of the pandemic.

Further aligning with these standards, emergency preparedness is strengthened when venues maintain updated evacuation plans, conduct regular drills, and ensure that all personnel understand their roles during emergencies, highlighting the importance of standard operating procedures (SOPs), coordination among staff, and continuous readiness training (Schütte et al., 2024). These procedures help sustain operational resilience and uphold guest safety.

Utilization of Technology

Hernandez (2023) states that technology utilization in MICE venues forms a core component of operational readiness, shaping how efficiently workflows run and how prepared venues are to meet event demands. This perspective supports findings that both digital systems and the personnel managing them directly influence daily operations and service quality (Zamzuri et al., 2023).

Maintaining uninterrupted power is important for sustaining event technologies in MICE venues, particularly through systems such as Uninterruptible Power Supplies (UPS). Continuous electricity prevents disruptions to projectors, LED walls, registration systems, Wi-Fi, and emergency communication tools, all of which can malfunction or halt when power drops even momentarily (Abaricia, 2023).

Adeyemo Babalola (2024) explains that virtual and hybrid event formats transformed the events industry by expanding reach, reducing travel-related costs, and

improving data collection through digital tools. These formats require venues to ensure stable internet connectivity, reliable backup systems, and high-quality audiovisual equipment supported by trained technical staff.

Mohd Nor et al. (2024) describe how, during the recovery period, technology strengthened business resilience by supplementing or replacing face-to-face interactions, enabling access to broader markets, and supporting safety compliance. This technological adaptability is closely tied to resilience indicators such as stable event delivery, consistent audience engagement, and more secure revenue flows.

Hybrid events during the pandemic succeeded through livestreaming platforms, video-communication tools, and online engagement features such as real-time Q&A, with their effectiveness depending on stable internet, clear audio-video output, trained technical personnel, and contingency planning (Karnadipa et al., 2022).

Light and Audiovisual Operation

Vencint Hernandez (2023) explains that the preparedness of lighting and audiovisual (AV) systems forms a critical foundation of MICE venue functionality, as these technologies directly influence communication clarity, event flow, and attendee engagement. His findings show that coordinated AV teams, well-maintained equipment, and dependable lighting controls are essential to prevent disruptions and support smooth event execution. In the Philippine event industry, this perspective is reflected in the

growing priority placed on synchronized AV operations, strategic equipment placement, and the presence of trained technical staff to meet post-pandemic demands.

Lighting and AV readiness requires end-to-end system reliability from signal sources to processing, distribution, and final display to ensure clear visuals, intelligible speech, and stable hybrid or in-person event delivery. Thoughtful lighting design, including adjustable LED fixtures, glare-free illumination, and zoning controls that improve stage visibility and audience comfort, is also essential. These standards align with global expectations for professional events, especially those involving keynote presentations, multimedia displays, and hybrid conferencing (AVIXA Announces 2021 AV Professional Awards at InfoComm, 2021).

Adeyemo Babalola (2024) notes that the rise of virtual and hybrid events has intensified the need for stronger AV capabilities, as livestreaming, high-quality audio, and reliable camera systems have become essential components of modern event management. His work illustrates how stable internet connectivity, synchronized microphones, and dependable projection systems contribute to seamless experiences for both onsite and online participants. These developments show that AV preparedness now extends beyond traditional equipment, encompassing digital integration and redundancy planning.

Hybrid events succeed when supported by continuous AV monitoring, skilled technical personnel, and backup systems that prevent disruptions during live sessions.

Coordinated audiovisual teams capable of addressing issues in real time are essential for ensuring operational resilience and sustained audience engagement. These factors highlight the importance of investing not only in equipment but also in the technical expertise required to operate it effectively (Karnadipa et al., 2022).

Power and Air-Conditioning Systems

Hernandez (2023) explains that the reliability of power and air-conditioning systems is a fundamental indicator of venue preparedness because these utilities directly influence comfort, safety, and the continuity of Meetings, Incentives, Conferences, and Exhibitions (MICE) events. Stable electrical systems, energy-efficient cooling units, and well-maintained ventilation help ensure that programs run smoothly without technical interruptions. These support not only attendee comfort but also the functioning of audiovisual equipment, lighting, and digital platforms used during events.

Air-conditioning and electrical power remain central to MICE readiness because heating, ventilation, and air-conditioning (HVAC) systems directly shape the event environment. Hybrid air-conditioning systems that combine direct expansion (DX) units with evaporative or desiccant components can reduce cooling energy use by up to 87% and demonstrate higher coefficients of performance (COP), although pilot testing and cost-effectiveness checks are still needed before broad adoption (Alghamdi & Krarti, 2025).

Agustin Vela et al. (2025) show that device-level reliability can be improved through microcontroller-based guards for window-type cooling units. These systems stabilize delay switching and monitor voltage and current in real time, offering better performance than earlier prototypes. Behavioral strategies, such as placing clear instructions or social-norm prompts in hotel rooms, also help guests choose more efficient temperature settings without lowering satisfaction. Electrical resilience is also vital for MICE operations, as events require continuous and stable power. This can be achieved by integrating distributed energy resources such as diesel generators and solar-storage systems, selecting appropriately sized batteries, and ensuring that automatic transfer switches function properly (Marqusee & Stringer, 2023).

Other Services

Other services within MICE venues such as housekeeping, sanitation, catering coordination, logistical support, and guest assistance play an essential role in overall preparedness because they support both the operational and experiential aspects of events. His findings indicate that these supplementary services ensure that venues remain clean, organized, and responsive to participant needs, contributing to the smooth flow of activities and the comfort of attendees throughout the event (Hernandez, 2023). These functions, while sometimes overlooked, are foundational to maintaining a high standard of service quality.

Quimba et al. (2021) highlight that the quality of "other services" in MICE venues depends on national-level digital readiness, including payment systems, regulations, internet connectivity, digital skills, and data governance. Issues such as limited trust, compatibility problems, and slow broadband continue to affect payment success, portal stability, and help-desk response times in the Philippines, making offline-capable multi-rail payments and multi-factor authentication (MFA) important improvements.

Service quality gaps exist in Dumaguete City's event industry, where guests often expect faster assistance, clearer information, and cleaner public areas. These concerns demonstrate that frontline help, housekeeping, sanitation, and food and beverage (F&B) services play a significant role in event satisfaction. In MICE settings, essential support services include reliable Wi-Fi, contactless registration and payment, multilingual signage, document support, and on-site information counters (Toledo, 2025)

Modern MICE success depends on technology integration, experiential quality, sustainability efforts, and a skilled workforce. Digital platforms, mobile applications, virtual tools, and coordinated staff all help streamline operations and improve attendee experience (Nilufar et al., 2025). These factors align closely with how "other services" are evaluated in readiness assessments.

Event Services

Hernandez (2023) states that event services are a key component of venue preparedness because they ensure smooth program delivery, guide participants throughout their experience, and support organizers' operational needs. The study emphasizes that well-coordinated teams such as ushers, coordinators, technicians, and other support staff help maintain order during transitions and address participant concerns immediately, resulting in better event flow and higher attendee satisfaction. These functions place event services at the center of Meetings, Incentives, Conferences, and Exhibitions (MICE) readiness and competitiveness.

MICE activities can contribute to inclusive development when local communities, small businesses, and government partners participate in planning and running events. Such cooperation spreads economic benefits, strengthens skills, and promotes safe and culturally respectful event practices. Improved transportation, basic facilities, and strategic marketing also help destinations attract more organizers (Ali Haider, 2024).

Firman Sinaga et al. (2020) report that in Bali, more event operations are adopting green practices such as waste reduction, coordinated transport, and digital recordkeeping. Their work notes that although these practices support sustainability goals, limited budgets and specific client demands sometimes prevent full compliance. This shows how environmental efforts are becoming an increasingly important part of event service quality.

Hosting major sports events can enhance a country's soft power, or its ability to gain positive global attention through attraction rather than force. Such events improve a nation's image, increase media coverage, and encourage tourism, business cooperation, and cultural exchange. These outcomes demonstrate how large-scale events support broader social and economic objectives (Alshikhy et al., 2025).

Creative tourism, which brings local arts, culture, food, and hands-on activities into meetings and conventions, can strengthen the MICE industry by making events more memorable and spreading income to local small businesses, thereby helping build a destination's brand. This supports the idea that cultural integration enhances event services and improves overall attendee experience (Fernali & Disimulacion, 2024).

Coordination and Service Improvement

Hernandez (2023) explains that coordination and service improvement are essential to venue preparedness because they allow teams, departments, and service units to work together efficiently in Meetings, Incentives, Conferences, and Exhibitions (MICE) operations. The study notes that clear communication channels, standardized procedures, and well-defined responsibilities help reduce delays and prevent service gaps during events. It further highlights that venues with strong coordination adapt more easily to unexpected changes, resolve issues quickly, and maintain consistent operations.

Gooding et al. (2022) state that service reliability increases when departments collaborate effectively and use feedback to guide improvements. Their work points out that clear roles, shared goals, and strong communication are especially important in complex organizations. The authors also emphasize that these factors reduce errors, strengthen responsiveness, and support stable event delivery.

Service quality improves when teams work well together and handle concerns immediately. Good service depends on more than polite or friendly staff; it requires clear duties, efficient communication between units such as front desk, housekeeping, maintenance, and food and beverage (F&B), and consistent follow-through on issues. These practices help meet attendee expectations and raise service ratings (Genove & Tayco, 2024).

Global health conferences often experience participation gaps among attendees from low- and middle-income countries due to high fees, visa requirements, travel costs, language barriers, and limited childcare or disability access. These accessibility challenges influence event participation and attendee experience (Velin et al., 2021).

Staff Services

Staff services, including employee competence, communication, and safety behavior, are central to service quality and guest confidence in MICE venues. A strong safety climate increases motivation to follow safety guidelines and engage in safety

activities, shaped by transparent managerial communication and the handling of incidents such as COVID-19. Clear communication and a supportive organizational culture strengthen frontline service reliability (Kim et al., 2021).

Employee appearance, effective communication, and proactive attention to client needs are major contributors to satisfaction in hotel-based MICE settings, and these employee factors influence customer loyalty by shaping how guests evaluate service interactions (Kumar & Samtani, 2021).

Kim et al. (2024) examine 2,339 Google Maps reviews of the Busan Exhibition & Convention Center (BEXCO) to identify venue attributes influencing satisfaction. Their analysis reveals three main themes MICE, Facility, and Environment and converts them into six underlying factors through exploratory factor analysis. The study reports that food and beverage, venue quality, event space, and parking are significant predictors of satisfaction, providing practical guidance for service improvement and capacity planning.

Age

Age plays an important role in understanding venue preparedness because different age groups perceive safety, technology, and event participation differently. His findings indicate that age affects how attendees assess readiness measures, comply with protocols, and engage with event processes, making it a relevant demographic factor in

MICE operations (Hernandez, 2023). Age differences shape not only comfort levels but also expectations in both physical and technological aspects of event experiences.

Haghani et al. (2023) explain that older adults tend to behave more cautiously, follow safety instructions more strictly, and prioritize risk reduction, whereas younger adults value convenience, social interaction, and flexibility. Their research highlights that these behavioral tendencies influence how different age groups respond to venue layouts, movement flow, and health measures. Younger adults generally prefer user-friendly processes, while older adults appreciate clarity and predictability. In addition, Harnadi et al. (2025) found that younger individuals demonstrate greater comfort with digital systems, making them more adept at online registration, virtual platforms, and app-based communication. This suggests that age affects the ease with which attendees learn and adapt to digital tools used in modern events.

Thus, venues must ensure that technological systems remain simple and accessible for older participants while efficient and intuitive for younger users. Further evidence from Hinlayagan et al. (2022)indicates that most MICE attendees fall within the 20–39 age range, representing young professionals who seek learning, networking, and skill-building opportunities. This demographic trend shapes venue programming and influences the design of meeting spaces and technology-supported activities. Younger professionals tend to participate more actively in interactive sessions and hybrid formats. Likewise, event preferences vary across age groups, with younger audiences more

inclined toward entertainment-driven activities and older adults favoring cultural and traditional programs. This finding highlights the importance of offering age-diverse event content and adaptable venue design (Madeira et al., 2023).

Pandemic-era studies also show age-related differences in event engagement. Litvinova-Kulikova et al. (2023) report that older adults adhered more consistently to health protocols, while younger groups preferred hybrid and online participation. These differences reflect the varying comfort levels and expectations across age cohorts in both physical and digital settings.

Additionally, An et al. (2021) argue that age influences how attendees perceive satisfaction and service quality, reinforcing the need for venues to maintain accessible spaces, clear instructions, and inclusive design for all age groups. Their findings stress that events must accommodate diverse physical capacities and technological skills to deliver equitable experiences . Finally, Martín-Rojo & Gaspar-González (2025) show that digitalization in MICE affects attendees differently depending on age, with younger participants adapting more readily to apps, QR codes, and virtual tools, while older participants often require clearer guidance and on-site assistance. Their review underscores the need for age-responsive technology integration in venue preparedness.

Overall, the literature shows that age significantly shapes perceptions of safety, technology use, event preferences, and overall satisfaction, making it an essential demographic factor in evaluating venue readiness.

Sex

Sex is a relevant demographic factor in assessing venue preparedness because men and women may perceive safety, physical setup, and service delivery differently, influencing how they evaluate overall event readiness. His findings show that variations in expectations and comfort levels can shape how attendees interact with venue facilities and respond to operational processes an important consideration in MICE assessments (Hernandez, 2023).

In support of this, Millán et al. (2024) explain that men and women experience business and hospitality environments differently due to varying preferences, levels of engagement, and sensitivity to service quality. Their research indicates that these differences become even more pronounced in technologically integrated MICE settings, where the use of digital tools, hybrid formats, and on-site facilities may be evaluated differently by each sex (Millán et al., 2024). These distinct experiences can reveal service gaps that may not appear when analyzing the general attendee population.

Poquiz et al. (2023) the importance of gender inclusivity and workplace equity in hospitality and event settings. Their study shows that fair workplace policies, anti-harassment measures, equal training opportunities, and inclusive facility design contribute to safer and more comfortable event environments for all participants. These factors indirectly affect how men and women perceive venue preparedness, especially in spaces where staff support and safety protocols are visible. Gender-related differences

also appear in service and facility perception. Studies indicate that men and women may rate physical features, service quality, and operational systems differently, although some aspects such as digital interfaces or app usability may show similar satisfaction levels across sexes (Gandarosa, 2023). This suggests that gender effects vary across domains of event experience, with some areas showing stronger differences while others remain consistent between groups. Taken together, the literature demonstrates that sex influences how attendees perceive safety, service, and event environments, making it a critical demographic variable in venue preparedness assessments. By acknowledging these differences, event facilities can design more inclusive, responsive, and equitable event experiences for all participants.

Employment Status

Hernandez (2023) explains that employment status is an important demographic factor in assessing venue preparedness because individuals with different job roles and levels of work experience often vary in their expectations, familiarity with event processes, and overall evaluation of MICE operations. His findings suggest that professionals who frequently attend or organize events tend to possess more structured standards for venue safety, coordination, and technological readiness, while those with less exposure may rely more on basic comfort and accessibility cues when forming their perceptions. Disimulacion (2021) explains that employment status significantly influences preparedness, participation, and resilience within the Meetings, Incentives, Conferences,

and Exhibitions (MICE) industry. The study shows that widespread job losses during the COVID-19 pandemic pushed many workers into part-time or freelance roles, which reduced stability, disrupted services, and slowed the pace of recovery (Disimulacion, 2021).

Technological change has reshaped the competencies needed in the MICE workforce, with digital proficiency, creativity, and adaptability now forming core components of job readiness. These skills support employment security and the effective use of information and communication technologies (Liu et al., 2022). Hybrid employment structures, such as project-based and off-site work, have also become more common in many regions. While these arrangements increase flexibility, they may weaken motivation, disrupt training continuity, and diminish long-term readiness, which can affect service quality and organizational resilience (Litvinova-Kulikova et al., 2023).

Wiengarten et al. (2021) report that "precarious work," including casual, contract, and gig employment, produces mixed effects on performance within service industries. Their analysis shows that these employment arrangements can heighten safety and operational risks, suggesting the need for stronger staff oversight, clearer instructions, and additional supervision when organizations depend on temporary crews.

1.3 Theoretical Framework

This study uses Donabedian's Structure–Process–Outcome (1966) (SPO) framework. Structure refers to the venue's physical and organizational setup, meeting and function

rooms, public areas, and safety, security, and emergency features. The process covers two core parts of event operations: (1) technology (lighting and AV, power and air conditioning/air exchange, Wi-Fi, and related facilities) and (2) event services (coordination and improvement systems, staff skills, and protocol communication). Outcome is the venue's overall readiness to host events safely and efficiently. Grouping the variables as Structure → Process → Outcome shows a simple idea: stronger facilities and better operating practices should lead to higher readiness. This layout follows the domains used in earlier anchored research and in the study instrument.

To make readiness measurable, the study also applies the ASEAN MICE Venue Standards (AMVS, 2018) and the World Travel & Tourism Council Global Protocols for the New Normal (2020). These standards set clear, checkable items across physical layout, meeting technology, and service operations for example, visible safety signs and evacuation plans; reliable power/HVAC and AV; stable internet and hybrid capability; and clear communication, feedback, and staff training. Using the same criteria allows direct comparison with prior Philippine venue-readiness work. The design is quantitative and descriptive — correlational, so it can describe preparedness by domain, test links among domains, and check for differences by respondent or event profile. Earlier findings suggest service coordination can vary by the most significant event type attended, a context effect that this study will also examine. The study keeps the same Likert scale and analytic tools (frequencies, percentages, means, correlations) for consistency.

1.4 Schematic Diagram

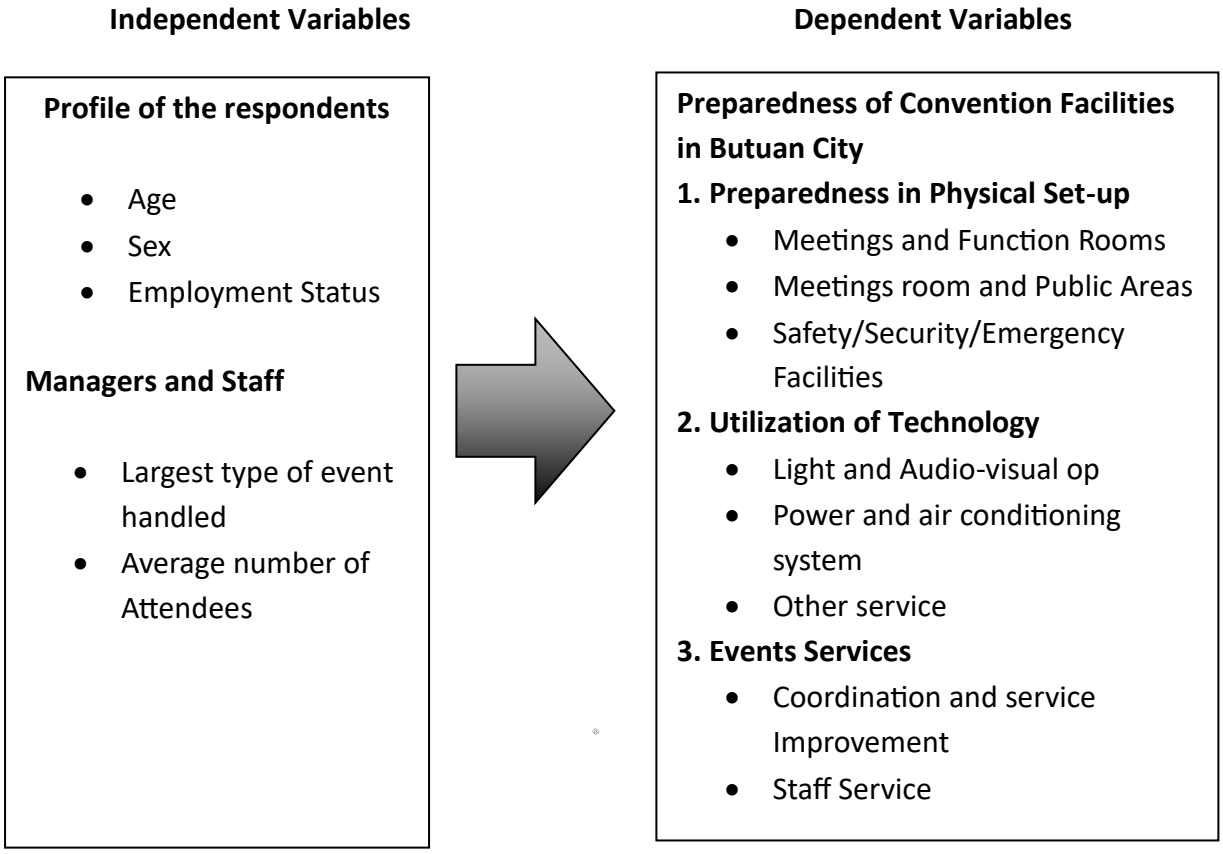


Figure 1. The Schematic Diagram shows the relationship between the dependent and independent variables.

1.5 Statement of the Problem/ Objectives of the Study

This study will assess the preparedness of convention and event facilities in Butuan City in accommodating Meetings, Incentives, Conferences, and Exhibitions (MICE) events. Specifically, it will seek to answer the following questions:

1. What is the demographic profile of the respondents in terms of:

   1.1 Age

   1.2 Sex;

   1.3 Employment Status;

   1.4 Largest type of event handled;

   1.5 Average number of attendees?

2. What is the level of preparedness of convention and event facilities in terms of physical setup, particularly regarding:

   2.1 Meetings and function rooms

   2.2 Meeting and public areas; and

   2.3 Safety, security, and emergency facilities?

3. What is the extent of utilization of technology in terms of:

   3.3 Light and audio-visual operations

   3.4 Power and air conditioning; and

   3.5 Other technological services?

4. What is the extent or level of events and services offered by the facilities in terms of:

4.1 Coordination and service improvement

4.2 Staff services?

5. Is there a significant relationship among the preparedness in physical setup, utilization of technology, and event services of selected convention and event facilities in Butuan City?

1.6 Hypothesis

The hypothesis guided the study and was tested at the level of significance.

H0 There is no significant relationship among the preparedness in physical setup, utilization of technology, and events services of selected convention and event facilities in Butuan City**.**

1.7 Scope and Limitation

The study will focus on assessing the preparedness of convention and event facilities in Butuan City in accommodating Meetings, Incentives, Conferences, and Exhibitions (MICE). The variables will include: (1) Physical Set-Up; (2) Technology Utilization; and (3) Event Services, with emphasis on Coordination and Service Improvement. This study will be applied only to convention and event facilities within Butuan City and will not include suppliers, destination managers, or other local government stakeholders. The primary data source will be a researcher-made questionnaire that will be administered to the identified respondents. Accordingly, the study will allow for significant observations about convention and event facility preparedness within a delineated geographic area, while being limited by the scope of respondents and the methodology that will be employed.

1.8 Definition of Terms

For a better understanding and classification, the following terms and words were operationally defined as follows:

Age. This term refers to the number of years the respondent has lived at the time of data collection and is used as a demographic characteristic.

Average Number of Attendees. This term refers to the usual number of participants present in events hosted by the facility, categorized into one hundred attendees and below, one hundred one to two hundred fifty attendees, two hundred fifty-one to five hundred attendees, and five hundred one attendees and above.

Convention. This term refers to an organized and scheduled gathering of individuals from professional, academic, civic, or industry groups that require meeting rooms, public areas, audio-visual support, and coordinated event services.

Convention and Facilities. This term refers to hotels and convention centers in Butuan City capable of hosting meetings, incentives, conventions, and events. It refers to establishments such as Hotel Oazis, Balanghai Hotel and Convention Center, Chikara Dottie's Place, VCDU Prince Hotel Grand Convention Center, and Icon Suites and Convention Center Incorporated. It also refers to their physical set-up, utilization of technology, and event services.

Coordination and Service Improvement. This term refers to the systems and procedures provided by the facility, including room capacity information, single-stop assistance,

feedback mechanisms, pre-arrival risk assessments, and communication of hygiene and distancing measures.

Employment Status. This term refers to the respondent's current work category, such as employed, unemployed, self-employed, part-time, or retired.

Event Services. This term refers to the assistance and support the venue provides before, during, and after the event, including coordination efforts, enhanced service delivery, and responsiveness of staff.

Largest Type of Event Handled. This term refers to the most significant type of event the respondent or facility has handled, such as meetings, conventions or conferences, exhibitions or events, or training programs.

Light and Audio-Visual Operations. This term refers to the lighting systems and audio-visual equipment available in the venue, including stage lighting, audience lighting, projector and screen clarity, microphone quality, and trained personnel managing the controls.

Meeting Room and Public Areas. This term refers to the common spaces within the facility, such as restrooms, hallways, cafeterias, smoking areas, parking areas, drop-off and pick-up points, and sanitation stations. It refers to their cleanliness, ventilation, and signage.

Meetings and Function Rooms. This term refers to the rooms used for seminars, conferences, meetings, and workshops. It refers to their cleanliness, capacity, ventilation, layout, furnishings, and signage.

Other Services. This term refers to additional technological and administrative services provided by the facility, such as wireless internet access, contactless registration, contactless payment, photocopying, scanning, faxing, contact tracing, vaccination verification, and multilingual signage.

Power and Air Conditioning System. This term refers to the systems that provide electrical power and maintain indoor temperature and air movement. It refers to air exchange, cooling systems, emergency lighting, backup electrical supply, exhaust fans, universal electrical outlets, and air purification devices.

Preparedness in Physical Set-up. This term refers to the overall readiness of the venue's physical environment for hosting events. It refers to meeting rooms, public areas, and safety, security, and emergency facilities assessed based on standards aligned with the Association of Southeast Asian Nations Meeting, Incentive, Convention, and Events Venue Standards.

Safety, Security, Emergency Facilities. This term refers to the equipment and systems provided to ensure the safety of participants, including closed-circuit television, security personnel, fire protection equipment, evacuation procedures, isolation rooms, hygiene kits, and directional floor signs.

Sex. This term refers to the biological identification of respondents as male or female for demographic classification.

Staff Service. This term refers to the performance and conduct of personnel working in the venue, including competence, professionalism, communication skills, adherence to safety procedures, and ability to address guest concerns.

Utilization of Technology. This term refers to the technological systems used by the facility to support event operations, including lighting systems, audio-visual equipment, electrical power reliability, air conditioning performance, wireless internet access, contactless services, digital documentation, and quick response code based verification.

CHAPTER 2

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

This chapter discusses the research design, research locale, research respondents, and research instrument used in the study. It also explains the ethical standards, data gathering procedure, and statistical treatment involved.

2.1 Research Design

The researchers will employ a quantitative research design to evaluate the preparedness of selected convention and event facilities in Butuan City in three areas: physical setup, technology usage, and event services.

The study will collect quantitative data through surveys from two groups: (a) internal operators (managers, event's organizers and front-office staff, safety personnel) and (b) external attendees (delegates/participants and client-organizers who attended events in the selected venues). This approach allows Analysis by respondent profile and supports comparisons across facilities. The survey will be anchored on Hernandez (2023) and patterned after a Philippine study on venue preparedness. An adapted questionnaire based on the ASEAN MICE Venue Standards (2018) and the World Travel & Tourism Council Global Protocols for the New Normal (2020) will be the primary data-collection tool.

2.2 Research Locale

This study will be conducted in Butuan City, Agusan del Norte, a growing hub for business, civic, and academic events in the Caraga Region. The locale aligns with the assessment of preparedness because hotels and convention facilities often host meetings, training sessions, conferences, and social events. In these settings, physical setup, technology use, and event services are visible and comparable.

The research will focus on five convention-capable establishments: Hotel Oazis (Oazis Hotel & Convention Center) on J.C. Aquino Avenue; Balanghai Hotel & Convention Center on Bacolod Street, Upper Doongan; Chikara Dottie's Place on J.C Aquino Avenue, Butuan City; VCDU Prince Hotel Grand Convention Center on Ilang- Ilang St. Villa Kananga, Butuan City and Icon Suites and Convention Center , Inc. on Butuan City. Each site offers operating conditions that are relevant to the study.

Placing the study across these locations enables a contextual assessment of readiness in the core areas. The environment supports systematic observation and comparison of (a) physical configuration (capacity, layout, safety, and movement), (b) technology use (lighting, audiovisual operations, connectivity, and power/HVAC uptime), and (c) event services (staffing, coordination, and guest assistance). Differences across sites in Butuan City will make the findings useful for venue managers, event planners, and other stakeholders.

2.3 Research Environment, Population and Sample

The study will be conducted in selected convention and event facilities in Butuan City, particularly in hotels and establishments that are accredited and recognized by the Department of Tourism (DOT). These venues include Oazis Hotel, Balanghai Hotel, VCDU Prince Hotel Grand Convention Hall, Icon Suites and Convention Center, Inc., and Chikara Dottie's Place, which serve as the primary research sites.

		POPULATION			**SAMPLE**		
Hotel	**MALE**	**FEMALE**	**TOTAL**	**MALE**	**FEMALE**	**TOTAL**	**%**
OAZIS	1,191	1,191	2,382	73	73	145	40.3
BALANGHAI	164	344	508	10	21	31	8.6
VCDU PRINCE HOTEL GRAND CONVENTION HALL	349	454	803	21	28	49	13.6
ICON SUITES AND CONVENTION CENTER, INC	81	39	120	5	2	7	2.0
CHIKARA DOTTIE'S PLACE	1,183	914	2,097	72	56	128	35.5
Total	**2,968.00**	**2,942.00**	**5,910**	**181**	**180**	**361**	**100**

Table 1. Population of Respondents

2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan

Research Instrument

The study will use a standardized questionnaire adapted from the research of Hernandez (2023) entitled *"Preparedness of Convention and Event Facilities in the New Normal in Batangas."* The instrument will be anchored on the ASEAN Meetings, Incentives, Conventions, and Exhibitions Venue Standards (2018) and the Global Protocols for the New Normal of the World Travel and Tourism Council (2020), which were also utilized in the study of Hernandez. The instrument will consist of three major parts. Parts II and III will contain 30 items that will be rated on a four-point Likert scale: 4 (Strongly Agree), 3 (Agree), 2 (Disagree), and 1 (Strongly Disagree).

Part I will gather the respondents' profiles, including age, sex, role or affiliation (such as venue staff, manager, attendee, or client), name of venue, the most significant type of event handled or attended (meeting, convention or conference, exhibition or event, or training), and the average number of attendees. Part II will measure the preparedness of the physical set-up, specifically meeting and function rooms, meeting and public areas, and safety, security, and emergency facilities. Part III will assess operational preparedness by evaluating technology utilization such as lighting and audiovisual operations, power and air-conditioning systems, and other services as well as event services, including coordination and service improvement and staff service.

The instrument will be used to assess the preparedness of convention and event facilities in Butuan City and will serve as a basis for guiding programs aimed at improving physical set-up, technology utilization, and service delivery across the selected venues.

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

A. Intellectual Property Right

This study will uphold intellectual property rights by strictly maintaining respondent anonymity throughout the research process. All secondary data, literature, and scholarly works incorporated into the study will be properly cited to acknowledge their original authors. The researchers' own ideas and outputs will also be protected in accordance with academic integrity guidelines.

B. Informed Consent

The respondents will be formally identified representatives of convention and facilities in Butuan City (e.g., managers, supervisors, or designated staff). The respondents will undergo a brief orientation conducted by the researchers to better understand the purpose of the study on facility preparedness for MICE, as well as the potential benefits and risks before agreeing to participate. The respondents will be informed of their right to withdraw from the study at any time without any explanation. During the orientation, a written consent form will be distributed to each respondent to ensure they fully understand their rights.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

All personal and organizational information obtained during the study will be treated with strict confidentiality. The data will only be collected with explicit consent from the respondents through the informed consent form. All responses will be anonymized through assigned identification codes, and only the researchers will have access to the master list linking codes to respondents. Questionnaires will be administered under supervised conditions to safeguard respondent privacy. All data will be securely stored, and confidentiality will be maintained throughout the entirety of the research process.

D. Voluntary Participation

Participation in this study will be completely voluntary. Respondents will be informed of their right to refuse or withdraw at any point without facing any negative consequences. Since no animals will be involved in the study, ethical considerations regarding animal use will not apply.

E. Minimization of Harm

The researchers will engage with the respondents respectfully and professionally to establish a safe and supportive environment throughout the study. Suppose any risks are associated, such as discomfort in providing organizational information. In that case, respondents will be referred to the appropriate support services designated by their institution or the researchers' institution to ensure their well-being. After participation, researchers will provide a debriefing session to ensure

no physical, psychological, or emotional harm occurs throughout the research process. The study will not involve animal subjects; the 3Rs principles of replacement, reduction, and refinement will not apply.

F. Beneficence

This study will contribute to a better understanding of the preparedness of convention and event facilities in Butuan City to accommodate MICE events. The study's findings will be available upon request from the respondents. The benefits of the study will focus on improving facility readiness and service coordination and will be based on the results of the study.

G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection

Respondents will be selected using well-defined, fair inclusion and exclusion criteria to ensure the selection process aligns with the study's objectives. Respondents from diverse backgrounds and facility types (e.g., hotels with function spaces, convention centers, and standalone event venues) will be included in a fair and nondiscriminatory manner. The list provided by the Department of Tourism (DOT) will serve as the initial sampling frame. The Researchers issued formal letters of approval to thirteen (13) establishments; however, only five (5) of these establishments responded to the communication. These five responding establishments will be considered as potential participants, provided that they meet the study's inclusion criteria. Establishments that

declined participation, either by explicitly refusing or by failing to respond to the formal communication, will be excluded from the study.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

Data collection and Analysis will be conducted using standardized methods to ensure accurate and reliable results. Initially, the researchers will submit a formal request to the relevant local offices (e.g., City Tourism Office/DOT regional listings) and facility management to obtain the complete list of eligible facilities and authorized respondents for the study. All findings will undergo careful review to avoid potential bias or error, and no limitations will be identified in the study.

I. Transparency in Reporting

The findings of the study will be reported honestly, with no manipulation or alteration of data. All sources such as academic references will be properly cited and acknowledged to ensure respect for intellectual property rights and uphold ethical research standards. This study will utilize some AI tools to support various aspects of the research. There will be no potential conflict of interest involved in the study.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

No patented materials will be involved in this study. All copyrighted materials including references, will be properly cited in accordance with intellectual property laws. The researchers will ensure that all sources are appropriately

acknowledged, maintaining academic integrity and avoiding any form of plagiarism.

K. Considerations for Human Subjects

The researchers will inform the respondents about the possible risks and potential benefits of the study, ensuring that an informed consent form will be provided**.** If any significant risks are present, such as emotional, physical, or psychological risks, an appropriate health monitoring program and emotional support services will be available.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Related Technology

The researchers will use digital technologies throughout the research process, including finding reliable articles to maintain the study's accuracy and credibility. AI tools, such as ChatGPT**,** will be utilized to assist in summarizing statements and enhancing the quality of the study. Platforms such as Google Scholar, Elicit, and Typeset.io will be used to identify supporting studies, ensuring the reliability and credibility of the research. Additionally, Grammarly will be used to ensure that the research report adheres to proper grammar and clarity standards. The responsible use of technologies will help maintain the integrity of the study.

M. Ethical Approval

The research will obtain ethical approval from the Institutional Review Board of Saint Michael College of Caraga, confirming its compliance with all relevant

guidelines on the protection of respondents, data privacy, and intellectual property rights.

2.6 Data Gathering Procedure

In gathering the data, the researchers will begin by sending a formal request letter to the Department of Tourism in Butuan City to obtain and confirm the official list of accredited convention and event facilities in the area. Once the endorsed list is received, the researchers will personally deliver permission letters to the managers of the selected venues Hotel Oazis, Icon Suites and Convention Center, Inc., Balanghai Hotel and Convention Center, Chikara Dottie's Place, and VCDU Prince Hotel Grand Convention Hall to secure their approval to conduct the study.

After all permissions are granted, the researchers will finalize the research instrument, which will be anchored on the indicators of the ASEAN MICE Venue Standards and the Global Protocols for the New Normal of the World Travel and Tourism Council. The instrument will undergo an expert validity review to ensure clarity, accuracy, and relevance to the objectives of the study. Following validation, pilot testing will be conducted, and the results will be submitted to the statistician to establish the instrument's reliability and finalize the questionnaire. Once the instrument is validated and completed, the researchers will coordinate with each participating venue to schedule the data collection. During the scheduled visits, the researchers will administer the questionnaires to the identified respondents, including internal operators such as managers, event or banquet staff, front-office personnel,

audiovisual or information technology staff, and safety officers, as well as external attendees such as delegates, participants, or client-organizers present during events. The researchers will ensure voluntary participation and adherence to ethical research standards throughout the process. After the data collection is finished, the researchers will tally, encode, and organize all responses for statistical processing. The encoded dataset will then be submitted to the statistician to ensure computational accuracy, verify data quality, and generate statistical tables aligned with the study's variables. Once the processed data are received, the researchers will analyze, interpret, and discuss the findings based on the statement of the problem and the study's domains: physical set-up, technology utilization, and event services. The results will be synthesized to draw conclusions and formulate recommendations on the preparedness of convention and event facilities in Butuan City.

2.7 Data Analysis Plan and Procedure

Statistical Treatment

In presenting, analyzing, and interpreting data, the researcher used the following statistical test, namely.

Frequency and Percentage – to describe the respondents' demographic profile (SOP 1).

Mean – to determine the level of preparedness in Physical Set-up (SOP 2).

Mean – to determine the extent of utilization in Light & Audio Visual / Power & Air Conditioning / Other Services (SOP 3).

Mean – to determine the level of Event Services (Coordination & Service Improvement; Staff Service) (SOP 4).

Correlational Analysis – to examine significant relationships among Physical Setup, Utilization of Technology, and Event Services (SOP 5).

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